



Protocol/sop for chain of custody

1. The practitioner must always keep the personal items of the deceased in good custody.
2. Records of all items/personal effects of a deceased must be properly documented with evidence.
3. The practitioner shall hand over the items to the next of kin of the deceased if known, or to a first degree relative of the deceased when available, else the items may be handed over to a family member of the deceased.
4. In situations when above are not satisfied, the practitioner shall hand over the items to the management of the facility until a suitable relative of the deceased is identified.
5. All illicit substances found on a deceased must be declared and reported to the appropriate authorities.
6. The details of a family member or appropriate authority who takes custody of the items of a deceased individual from a practitioner or management of the facility must be entered into the chain of custody records with name, location, designation, contact and signature or thumbprint and should be dated.